REQUEST FOR INFORMATION (RFI)

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE
OFFICE OF JUSTICE PROGRAMS
DATA ARCHIVING SERVICES

1.0 INTRODUCTION

This Request for Information (RFI) is the initiation of market research under Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 10. This is NOT a solicitation for proposals, proposal abstracts, or quotations. This announcement does not constitute an Invitation for Bids (IFB), Request for Quote (RFQ), or a Request for Proposal (RFP), and it should not be construed as a commitment of any kind by the Government to issue a formal solicitation or ultimately award a contract. Responses to this notice shall not be accepted as offers or quotes.

The Government anticipates utilizing the North American Industry Classification System (NAICS) Code 541611 – Administrative Management and General Management Consulting Services if this anticipated requirement proceeds to the solicitation phase. However, the Government is open to industry input on a more appropriate NAICS Code based on industry's understanding of the anticipated requirement. The anticipated contract type is Firm Fixed Price (FFP). The anticipated Period of Performance is a base period of 12 months and up to four (4) 12-month option periods. Respondents should ensure that they are properly registered in the Government System for Award Management at SAM.gov.

The Office of Justice Programs (OJP) is issuing this RFI to identify qualified and responsible vendors (including small business vendors with the following designations: 8(a), Service-Disabled Veteran Owned Small Business, Historically Underutilized Business Zone (HUBZone) Small Business, Small Disadvantaged Business, Veteran-Owned Small Business, Women-Owned Small Business, and Economically Disadvantaged Women-Owned Small Business) having an interest in and possessing the resources and expertise to provide support to the Bureau of Justice Statistics ((BJS) in providing data archiving services.

The Department of Justice's Office of Justice Programs (OJP) is issuing this Request for Information (RFI) to gather information from qualified organizations about data archiving services to modernize and reduce costs, while also complying with legislation that mandates data security, confidentiality protection, and continuity for all users of OJP data.

IMPORTANT NOTICE: This is a REQUEST FOR INFORMATION only and does not constitute a solicitation. The federal government will not pay for information provided and will not compensate respondents for costs incurred. This RFI does not obligate the government to award a contract. All information received that is marked as proprietary will be handled accordingly.

2.0 BACKGROUND

Since 1978, OJP has maintained the National Archive of Criminal Justice Data (NACJD) to preserve and disseminate federally funded criminal and juvenile justice datasets. The archive contains

microdata for approximately 1,000 data collections (3TB archival storage, 1TB active dissemination), including:

- **Longitudinal surveys** (National Crime Victimization Survey, multi-decade cohort studies)
- **Statistical collections** (National Prisoner Statistics, Uniform Crime Reports, Deaths in Custody)
- **Evaluation data** (randomized controlled trials, multi-site program evaluations)
- **Administrative records** (criminal history, court case files, linked multi-agency data)
- **Complex data types** (geospatial crime data, qualitative interviews, emerging audio/video)

Current operations employ approximately 15 specialized staff (curators, statisticians, metadata specialists, criminologists) expending approximately 2,000 staff hours monthly. The archive processes 30-50 new datasets annually, serves 15,000+ unique users, handles 100,000+ downloads, and manages 500+ restricted-use data applications and 50+ active Virtual Data Enclave projects annually.

Data sensitivity varies significantly which requires management via tiered access:

- **Public-use files** (40% of collections): Direct download with disclosure limitation applied
- **Restricted-use files** (50%): Require Institutional Review Board (IRB) approval, signed Data Use Agreements, security plans, and output review.
- **Enclave-only data** (10%): Same requirements as restricted-use, but accessible only through a Virtual Data Enclave.

The federal legal and policy framework governing these activities requires compliance with various federal directives, including the data use and confidentiality provisions in 34 U.S.C. §§ 10134 and10231 and 28 CFR Part 22, the Federal Information Security and Management Act (FISMA), the Privacy Act, foundations for Evidence-Based Policymaking Act of 2018, Open Data Policy, Restoring Gold Standard Science, and the Federal Zero Trust Strategy and recent Executive Orders on making federal data Super Intelligence (SI) ready and accessible.

3.0 KEY CHALLENGES AND INNOVATION GOALS

OJP seeks information about how organizations address:

- **Scale and complexity:** Growing data volumes with increasingly complex types
- **Confidentiality protection:** Managing data containing personally identifiable information
- **Metadata complexity:** Creating Data Documentation Initiative (DDI)-compliant metadata
- **Specialized workflows:** Disclosure risk assessment requiring statistical expertise
- **Security requirements:** FISMA MODERATE authorization minimum; FedRAMP compliance

- **Technological innovation:** Potential applications of Super Intelligence (SI)[1]
- **Operational continuity:** Seamless transition from existing providers with no disruption

4.0 REQUESTED INFORMATION

Please address topics relevant to your organization's expertise. **Refer to the accompanying Performance Work Statement for detailed technical requirements.**

4.1 Organizational Capability

Describe your organization's experience managing large research data repositories, particularly for sensitive social science or criminal justice data requiring confidentiality protection. Include examples involving knowledge of disclosure risk assessment and avoidance techniques, restricted data access management, or secure data enclaves.

4.2 Data Curation at Scale

Describe your approaches for:

- Processing diverse data types (survey data with complex weights, administrative records with millions of cases, geospatial data, qualitative transcripts)
- Creating DDI-compliant metadata for complex datasets (thousands of variables, multi-file structures, longitudinal designs) to support automation and responsible SI implementation.
- Conducting disclosure risk assessments and applying disclosure avoidance techniques
- Managing workflows for processing 30-50 datasets annually

4.3 Confidentiality and Security Infrastructure

Describe your:

- Experience operating systems that meet FISMA MODERATE standards or higher
- Approach to tiered data access
- Virtual Data Enclave capabilities

4.4 Data Dissemination and Access Management

Describe your:

- Experience managing projects that use restricted data and providing technical assistance to researchers

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[1] Per Executive Order 14434, "to the maximum extent permitted by law, executive departments and agencies (agencies) shall use 'Super Intelligence' and 'SI' in place of 'Artificial Intelligence' and 'AI' in official correspondence, public communications, websites, reports, policy documents, and other non-statutory documents within the executive branch."

- Platforms supporting 100,000+ annual downloads with 15,000+ unique users
- Experience managing 50+ concurrent secure enclave projects

4.5 Technology and Innovation

Describe:

- Current enterprise architecture and IT infrastructure
- FedRAMP authorization status
- Innovative approaches to responsible use of SI to optimize efficiency for archiving social science data

4.6 Cost Structures and Service Models

Provide general information about:

- Cost drivers in data archiving services (per-dataset, per-hour, subscription models)
- Experience with different service delivery models
- Cost implications of different approaches (**Note:** The government is not requesting specific pricing but seeking to understand cost structures for acquisition planning.)

4.7 Transition and Continuity

Describe experience and approach to:

- Transitioning complex systems, programs and specialized data work (e.g. disclosure review) from incumbent providers
- Maintaining operational continuity during transitions

5.0 INFORMATION SUBMISSION INSTRUCTIONS:

Format: Electronic submission (PDF preferred)

Required content:

- Brief description of capabilities in the following areas:
    - Data Curation at Scale
    - Confidentiality and Security Infrastructure
    - Data Dissemination and Access Management
    - Technology and Innovation
    - Cost Structures and Service Models

    - Transition and Continuity
- Responses to relevant RFI sections with clear section headings
- Vendor past performance information, especially for projects of similar size and complexity.
- Brief organizational background (may be in an appendix)

In addition to addressing the items above, the response should also include the following information:

1. Respondent's name, mailing address, points of contact information (email address and telephone number), website, SAM.gov Unique Entity ID (UEI), and Cage Code.
2. Respondent's current business designation and socioeconomic status.
3. Contractor's government-wide contracting vehicles (i.e., GSA Schedule Contract, OASIS, etc.).

The response to this notice is limited to 15 single-sided pages (including all attachments, charts, etc.). Cover page and introductory letter DO NOT count toward the 15-page limit. Telephone inquiries will not be accepted or acknowledged, and no feedback or evaluations will be provided to companies regarding their submissions. Interested vendors should monitor a government point of entry site for further information. Responses to this RFI are appreciated.

RESPONSE SUBMISSION DATE AND TIME
Responses to the information provided above are due no later than **Tuesday, November 10, 2026, at 5:00 PM Eastern Time**. Responses received after this date and time may not be considered.

DISCLAIMER AND IMPORTANT NOTES
This RFI is for information and planning purposes only and shall NOT be construed as a solicitation or as an obligation on the part of the Government. This notice does not obligate the Government to award a contract or otherwise pay for the information provided in the response. The Government reserves the right to use information provided by respondents for any purpose deemed necessary and legally appropriate. Any concern responding to this notice should ensure that their response is complete and sufficiently detailed to allow the Government to determine the concern's qualifications to perform the work.

Respondents are advised that the Government is under no obligation to acknowledge receipt of the information received or provide feedback to respondents with respect to any information submitted. After a review of the responses received, a pre-solicitation synopsis and solicitation MAY be published. However, responses to this notice will not be considered adequate responses to a solicitation.

The Government will NOT accept requests for meetings or briefings and may not answer any questions posed. No phone solicitations or email with regard to the status of a potential Request for

Quotes (RFQ) will be accepted prior to its release. Information and materials submitted in response to this notice WILL NOT be returned.

The Government will not pay for the preparation of any submitted information. As a result of this notice, the Government MAY issue a Request for Quote (RFQ). There is no solicitation available at this time. However, should such a requirement materialize, no basis for claims against the Government shall arise as a result of a response to this RFI or the Government's use of such information as either part of our evaluation process or in developing specifications for any subsequent requirement.

CONFIDENTIALITY
No proprietary, classified, confidential, or sensitive information should be included in your response. The Government reserves the right to use any non-proprietary technical information in any resultant solicitation(s).

END OF DOCUMENT